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SOUTHERN EUROPE SIZZLES AS SUMMER'S FIRST HEATWAVE HITS

People cool off underneath water fountains in the Madrid Rio recreation area during the first heatwave of the summer in Madrid, Spain, on Saturday. Authorities across Southern Europe urged people to seek shelter yesterday and protect the most vulnerable as punishing temperatures from Spain to Portugal, Italy and France climbed higher in the season's first major heatwave that is expected to last several days.

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Al Safa road project to cut travel time by 75%

Plan supports a high-profile district that includes major destinations

DUBAI
BY CHRISTIAN BORBON
Senior Web Editor

In line with the directives of the leadership to fast-track infrastructure projects and expand road capacity for smoother traffic flow across Dubai, the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) has announced a major upgrade aimed at cutting travel time by 75 per cent and doubling

12,000
vehicles per hour in both directions, up from 6,000, after project completion

vehicle capacity along a key corridor.

The Al Safa Street Improvement Project spans 1,500 metres, running from the junction with Shaikh Zayed Road to the junction with Al Wasl Street. The development includes the construction of two bridges and two tunnels,

with a combined length of 3,120 metres. The project also involves widening existing surface roads, upgrading key intersections, and modernising traffic signal systems to streamline flow through one of Dubai's busiest areas.

Once completed, travel time along Al Safa Street will drop from 12 minutes to just 3, and capacity will increase from 6,000 to 12,000 vehicles per hour in both directions.

The project supports a high-profile district that includes major destinations such as City Walk and the Coca-Cola Arena, and plays host to a range of tourism, cultural, and sporting events year-round.

Iran tells UN to hold Israel, US accountable

TEHRAN SAYS IT IS NOT CONVINCED ISRAEL WILL ABIDE BY A CEASEFIRE

TEHRAN

Iran demanded that the United Nations recognise Israel and the United States as being to blame for their recent 12-day war, in a letter to the secretary-general published yesterday.

"We officially request hereby that the Security Council recognise the Israeli regime and the United States as the initiators of the act of aggression and acknowledge their subsequent responsibility, including the payment of compensation and reparations," Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi wrote in the letter to UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres.

Iran also said yesterday it was not convinced Israel would abide by a ceasefire that ended their conflict last week.

The most serious escalation to date between the arch-foes erupted on June 13, when Israel launched a bombing campaign in Iran that killed top military commanders and scientists linked to its disputed nuclear programme.

Derailing talks

Israel said its aim was to keep the Islamic republic from developing a nuclear weapon — an ambition Tehran has consistently denied, insisting it has the right to develop nuclear power for civilian purposes like energy.

The fighting derailed nucle-

Trump has threatened further strikes should Iran enrich uranium to levels capable of manufacturing nuclear weapons.

ar talks between Iran and the United States, a staunch ally of Israel's.

"We did not start the war, but we have responded to the aggressor with all our power," Iran's armed forces chief of staff, Abdolrahim Mousavi, was quoted as saying by state television, referring to Israel.

"We have serious doubts over the enemy's compliance with its commitments including the ceasefire, we are ready to respond with force" if attacked again, he added, six days into the ceasefire announced by US President Donald Trump.

The United States joined Israel in its campaign during the war, carrying out strikes on three key facilities used for Iran's atomic programme.

Trump has threatened further strikes should Iran enrich uranium to levels capable of manufacturing nuclear weapons.

Meanwhile, an Israeli strike on Tehran's Evin prison during the war killed at least 71 people, Iran's judiciary said yesterday.

— AFP

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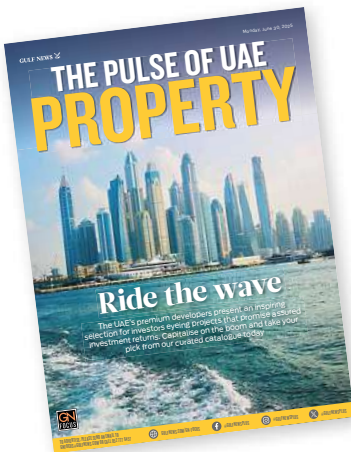
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